

UNIT 61



LIFE LATELY

CONVERSATION

Tim: You look totally wiped. What's been going on?

Ashley: Honestly? I've been burning the candle at both ends—between the kids, the house, and helping out my mom. I'm running on empty.

Tim: I feel that. I'm barely keeping it together myself—errands, appointments, family stuff. It's nonstop.

Ashley: Tell me about it. I clean one room, and somehow the rest of the house explodes. Feels like I'm just spinning my wheels.

Tim: Same here. And instead of helping, my partner keeps sweeping things under the rug—like ignoring it will make it disappear.

Ashley: Meanwhile, I'm racing the clock trying to stay on top of groceries, bills, school stuff...I'm constantly spinning plates.

Tim: And my teenager? Super moody. One tiny thing and it's a full-blown meltdown.

Ashley: Oh yeah, I've been walking on eggshells around mine—anything sets them off lately.

Tim: It's exhausting. I started hitting the gym super early, just to grab a quiet moment before the day explodes.

Ashley: That actually sounds smart. Can't say the same here. I'm paying for a membership I never use. I feel I'm throwing money down the drain.

Tim: Feels like we're all just trying to make it through the madness.

Ashley: Pretty much.



VOCABULARY



Burn the candles
at both ends



Spin the plates



Sweep under the
rug



Race the clock



Drag my feet



Throw money
down the drain



Hit the gym



Walk on eggshells

LANGUAGE PRACTICE



What **have you
been up to?**

**I have been racing
the clock because
of the project's
deadline.**



UNIT 61



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EXERCISE 1

Complete the sentences using the vocabulary of the unit and then your own ideas

- A. I have been burning the candle at both ends, because
_____.
- B. I _____ my feet when it comes to
_____.
- C. I _____ money down the drain by
_____.
- D. I _____ on eggshells around
_____.
- E. I _____ the clock to
_____.
- F. I _____ things under the rug instead of

EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentences using the vocabulary below and then your own ideas

burning the candle at both ends | dragging my feet | throwing money down the drain | walking on eggshells |

- A. I know I should've dealt with this problem earlier, but I
_____ because
_____.
- B. Lately, I _____ and I'm exhausted — I
barely get any rest.
- C. I think I've been _____ — I've been
buying things I don't even use.
- D. This week, I've been _____ to avoid
upsetting someone close to me.

SUMMARY

Question: Have/Has + subject + been + verb(-ing)?		- Have you been burning the candle at both ends? - Have you been dragging your feet? - Have you been throwing money down the drain? - Have you been walking on eggshells?
Affirmative: have/has + been + verb(-ing)	To talk about actions started in the past and still happening or just finished.	- Yes, I have been burning the candle at both ends all week. - Yes, I have been dragging my feet on that task. - Yes, I have been throwing money down the drain on shopping. - Yes, I have been walking on eggshells.
Negative: haven't/hasn't + been + verb(-ing)		- No, I haven't been burning the candle at both ends lately. - No, I haven't been dragging my feet recently. - No, I haven't been throwing money down the drain. - No, I haven't been walking on eggshells recently.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. have been burning the candle
- B. have been dragging
- C. have been throwing my
- D. have been walking
- E. have been working
- F. have been sweeping

Exercise 2

- A. dragging my feet
- B. burning the candle at both ends
- C. throwing money down the drain
- D. walking on eggshells